Dongguan Grocery Market
JiaRong SPAR, Competitors & Field-Visit Guide

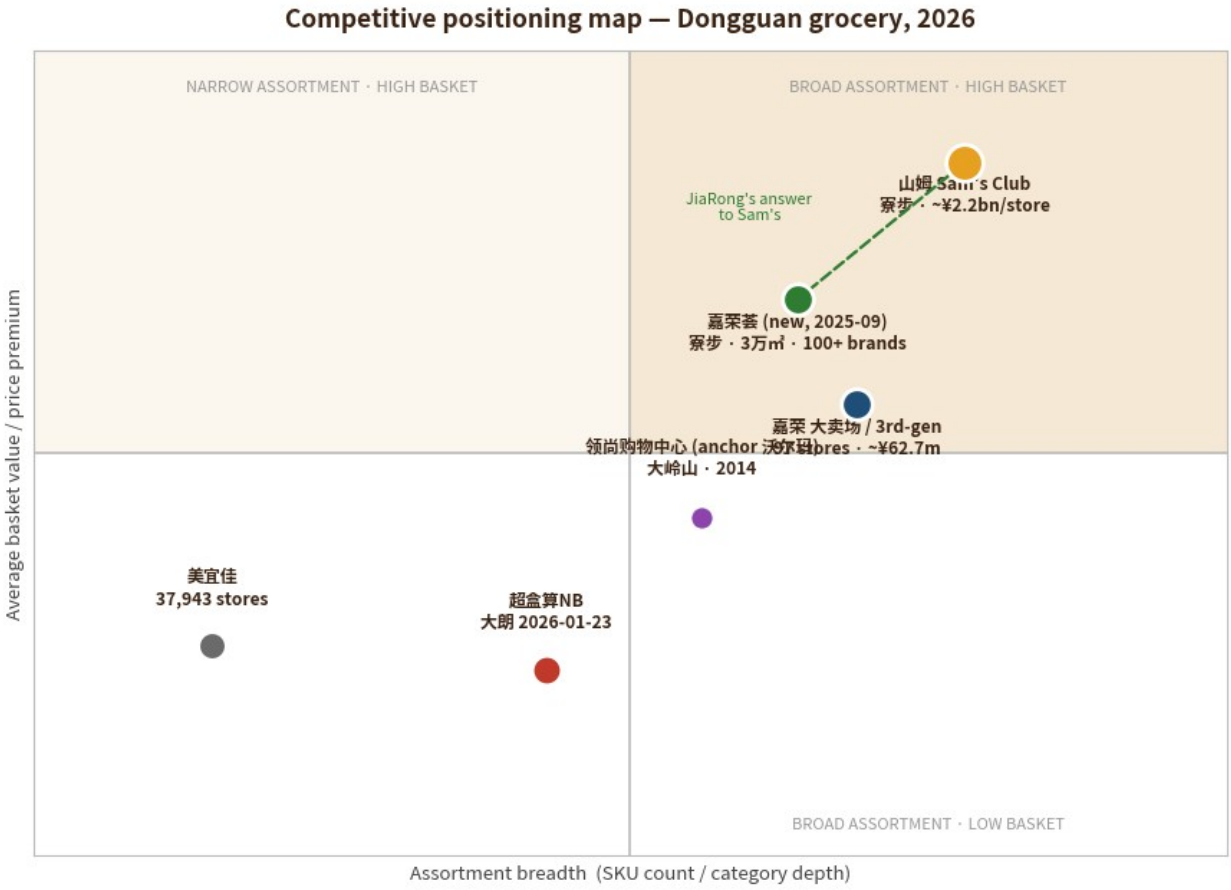
Consolidated briefing · 7 figures · base: 广东省东莞市大岭山镇石大路科技工业园 · for Gary Teh

This document consolidates three earlier artefacts: the Chinese-source line-item analysis, the competitive position / SWOT deck, and the venue shortlist into a single reference for the site visit. Every figure is tagged VERIFIED / REPORTED / ESTIMATE / TO CONFIRM. Estimates are labelled on the charts, not only in footnotes.

Executive summary — five things to know

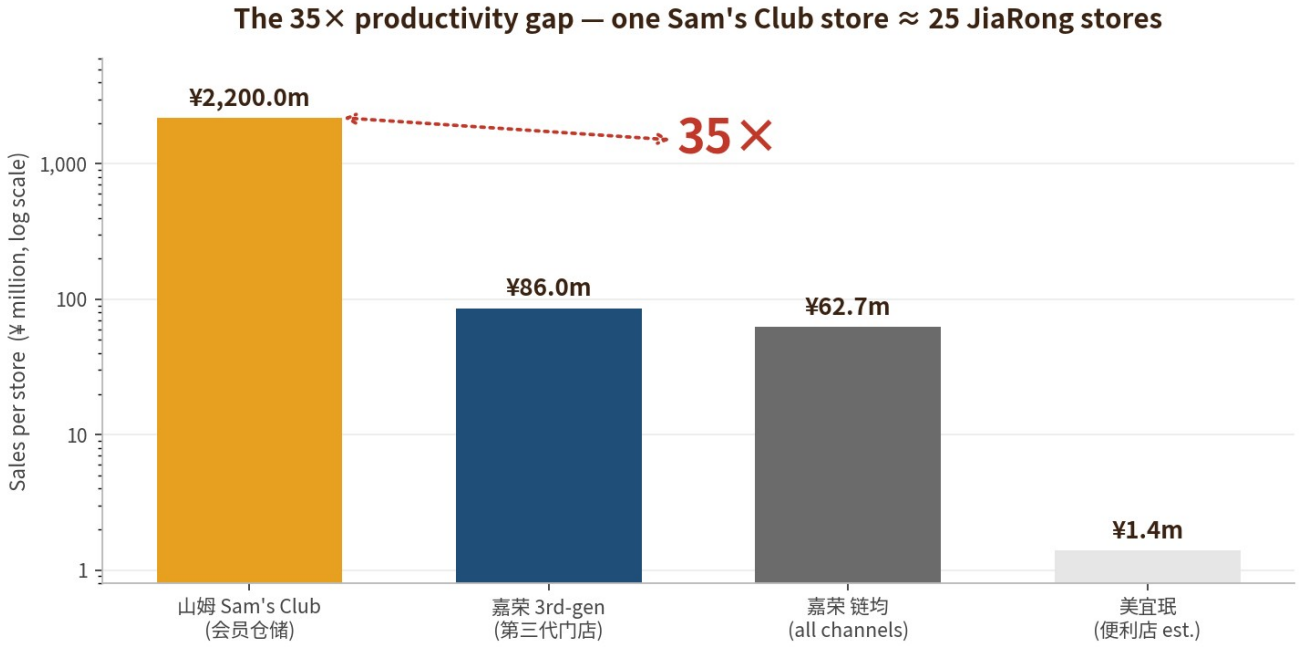
- The mid-tier is gone, and it left first. Carrefour exited Dongguan entirely (2023-12), ParknShop's last store 2021-01, Walmart 莞城西城楼 2019-06, Yonghui 东城万达 2025-07. The 100–8,000 m² band emptied before the discount tier even arrived.
- JiaRong is contracting deliberately, not collapsing. 105 → 97 supermarkets (−7.6%) while sales rose 6.5% to ¥60.80 亿. Fewer, better stores. Every closure in the source list is this strategy, not a crisis.
- The 35× productivity gap is a business model, not bad management. Sam's ~¥2.2bn/store vs JiaRong ~¥62.7m. ~4,000 SKUs serving a destination trip versus ~36,000 serving a top-up trip.
- The real threat is 10 km away. 超盒算 NB opened 大朗 2026-01-23, ~100 more South China stores planned 2026. A hard-discount operator that close sets a price ceiling in the channel that would otherwise absorb a ¥60–120 bar.
- Your base town is structurally weak for premium retail. 赛商网 states 大岭山 remains at the '百货、商业街的初期阶段' with population flowing out to 长安 and 虎门. Read the local shelf as a baseline, not as a market.

1. Competitive positioning map



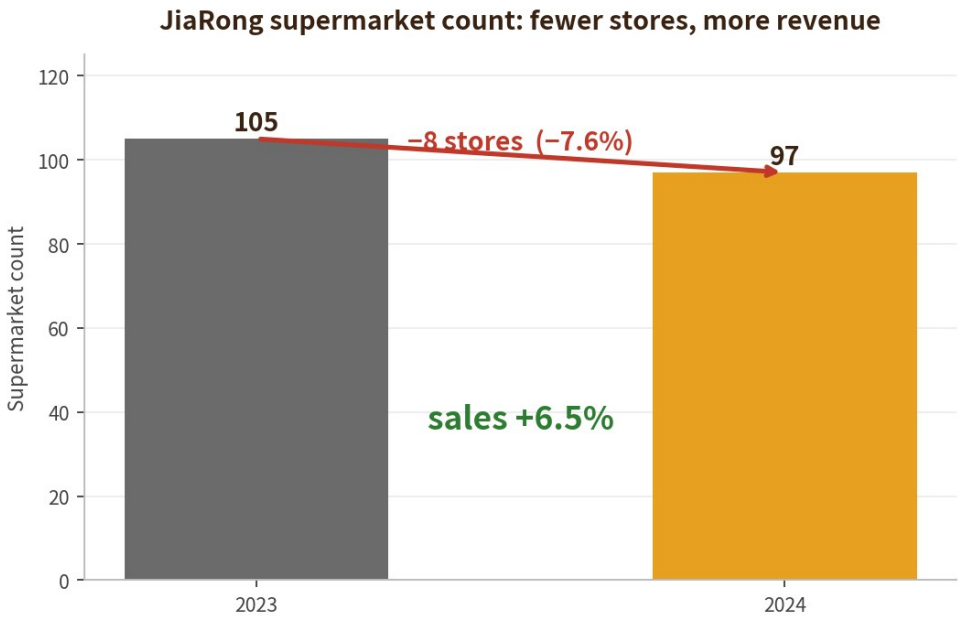
Axes are qualitative placements from disclosed format data, not measured coordinates — read relative position, not absolute values. The green arrow is the strategic story: JiaRong launched 超市 sub-brand 嘉荣荟 (寮步, 2025-09-28, 3 万㎡, 100+ brands) explicitly aimed at the Sam's tier. ESTIMATE / REPORTED.

2. The productivity gap



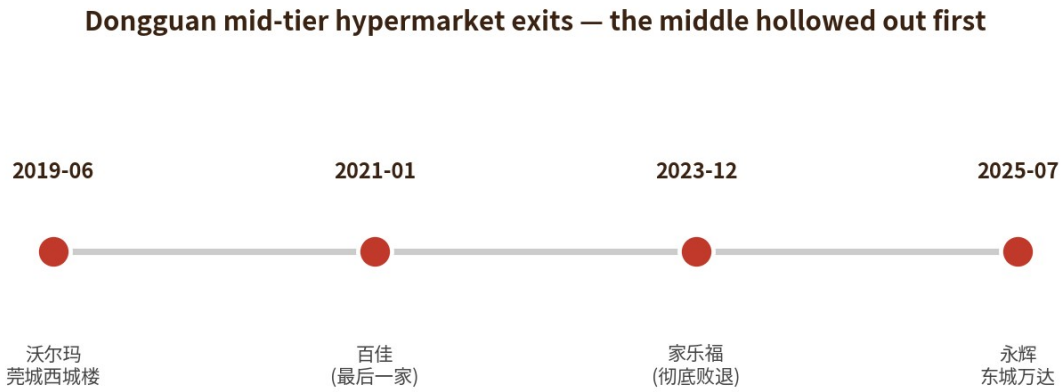
Sam's Club ~¥2.2bn/store (REPORTED, derived). JiaRong 3rd-gen ~¥86m (ESTIMATE: ¥60.80 亿 ÷ 97, uplifted). JiaRong chain average ~¥62.7m (VERIFIED arithmetic). 美宜珉 ~¥1.4m (ESTIMATE). Log scale — values printed above each bar because log bars mislead on their own.

3. JiaRong: fewer stores, more revenue



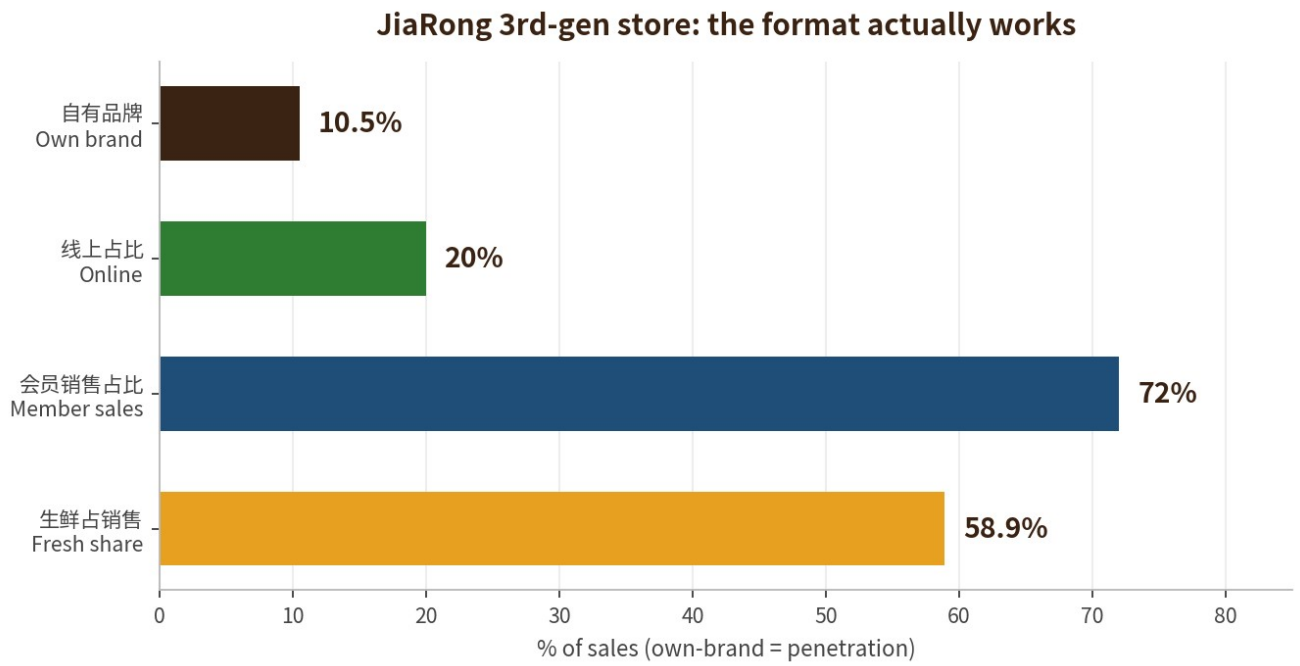
CCFA 2024 百强: 97 supermarkets, ¥60.80 亿, rank #28, sales +6.5% on store count −7.6%. A separate CCFA line shows ¥79 亿 at rank #62 across ~140 outlets all banners — different scope, also genuine. Do not present the two as contradictory; present them as two views. VERIFIED.

4. Who left the middle, and when



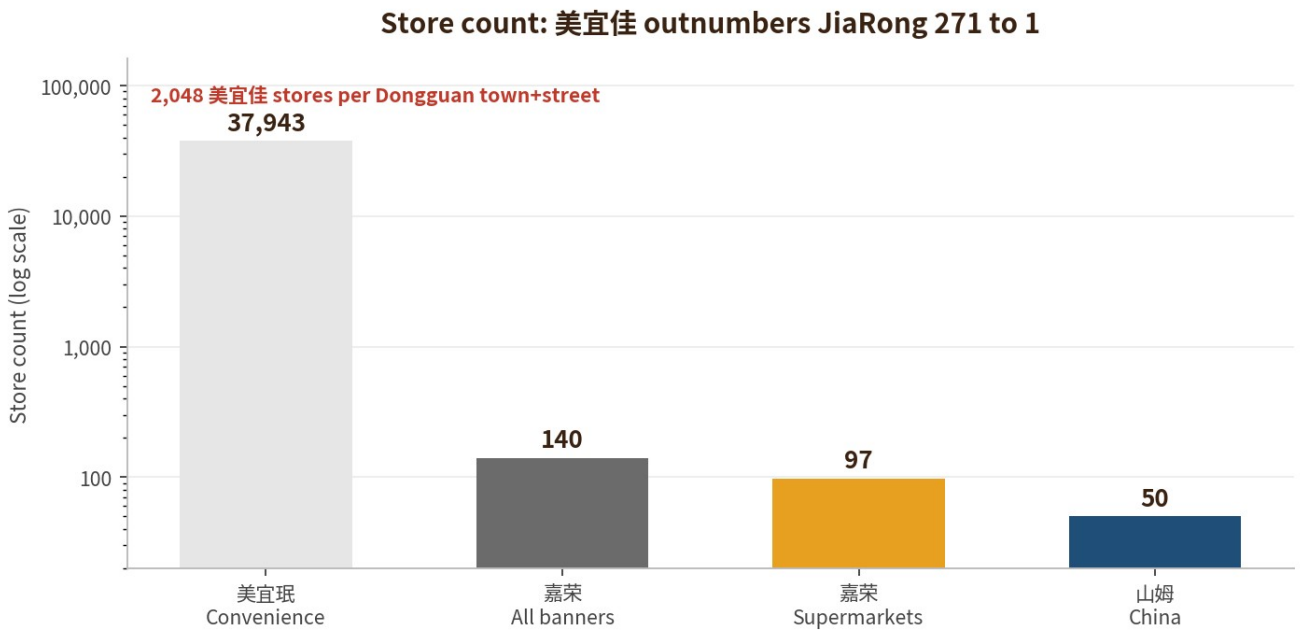
Dongguan mid-tier hypermarket exits, REPORTED across multiple outlets. The sequence matters more than the count: the mid-tier was already emptying for four years before 超盒算 NB arrived. Discount did not kill the hypermarket here — it moved into ground the hypermarket had vacated.

5. What is actually working inside JiaRong



3rd-gen store disclosures: 58.9% fresh share, 72% member sales, ~20% online, 10.5% own-brand penetration. REPORTED. These are not the numbers of a failing operator. The format works; it is out-scaled by a model that needs 4,000 SKUs instead of 36,000.

6. Scale



美宜珉 37,943 stores nationally, 2,048 per Dongguan town/street — the highest convenience density in China (VERIFIED registry). Dongguan is a 直筒子市: 4 streets + 28 towns, no districts. Consumption is structurally dispersed, which is precisely the terrain where convenience caps basket size.

7. SWOT

JiaRong SPAR — SWOT (evidence-tagged)



Reading it

One sentence carries the whole analysis: good store, wrong decade. JiaRong's upgraded format posts genuinely competitive metrics, and it has responded properly — the 嘉荣荟 mall format is a real attempt to occupy the Sam's tier rather than fight it. What no incumbent can do is defend a mid-tier price band that both the membership tier above and the discount tier below are actively removing.

8. Competitor profiles

Operator	Format	Scale	Dongguan presence	Why it matters to us
山姆 **Sam's Club**	Membership warehouse	~55 stores China (2025-04); 2 in Dongguan	Dongguan #1 in 寮步镇; #2 signed for 厚街镇 2025-04-25, ¥5.11 亿, 2 万㎡, opens end-2026	Your pricing reference. The two SKUs photographed (每日黑巧 ¥99.9, Bouchard) live here.
嘉荣 **SPAR** / 嘉荣荟	Supermarket + mall	97 supermarkets; 嘉荣荟 3 万㎡ (2025-09-28)	寮步 (HQ-adjacent), 厚街, 东城; Dalingshan status unclear	SPAR member since 2006 — sole Guangdong legal entity. Import access is their one non-replicable asset.
超盒算 **NB (Hema)**	Hard discount	大朗卓为城 2026-01-23; ~100 South China planned 2026	大朗 — ~10 km from 大岭山	The actual threat. Sets a hard price ceiling in the discount channel.
美宜珉	Convenience	37,943 nationally;	everywhere, including 大	Structural cap on basket

		2,048/Dongguan town-street	岭山	size. Not a competitor for a premium bar — a competitor for the trip.
沃尔玛 **Walmart**	Hypermarket remnant	surviving Dongguan stores incl. 大岭山玉屏路分店	inside 领尚天地商住区, 107 国道北侧 — see §9	Now the anchor tenant of the very mall it once competed with.

9. Where to go — field-visit itinerary

Ordered by value to the positioning question, not by distance. Confirm hours on 高德 / 大众点评 before driving — I could not verify live trading status for most of these by search.

1. 山姆会员商店 东莞首店 · 寮步镇

HIGHEST PRIORITY. This is where the 每日黑巧 ¥99.9 and Bouchard reference photos came from. See the entire premium dark-chocolate set in one aisle, and note the per-kg maths: ¥99.9 for a 15 g × 13 daily pack.

→ The only place locally where premium dark chocolate is a DESTINATION category rather than a facing.

2. 领尚购物中心 + 沃尔玛大岭山玉屏路分店 · 大岭山镇

领尚天地商住区第 10 栋集中商业地上二三层, 107 国道北侧. Mall opened 2014 — the town's only real 购物中心, anchored by Walmart + 华夏太古影城.

→ Your local baseline. Read this shelf FIRST, before Sam's, so you know what the town actually offers.

3. 凯东中央街・天和百货 · 大岭山镇

The town-centre 商业组团 alongside 领尚 and 沃尔玛. Older 百货 format.

→ Shows the pre-upgrade tier — what JiaRong is retreating from, still trading.

4. 嘉荣荟 寮步店 (坑口红荔路景泰香都城) · 寮步镇

3 万㎡, opened 2025-09-28, 100+ brands, positioned 'young, fashion, trend'. Target: young + modern families. Claims 15 km catchment covering 东城, 松山湖 and 大岭山.

→ JiaRong's answer to Sam's. Judge whether a supermarket group can build a premium mall brand.

5. 嘉荣 大卖场 **(surviving old format)** · 东城 / 南城

Pick any surviving large-format store and compare directly against #4.

→ The contrast IS the finding: same operator, two formats, one being closed.

6. 超盒算 **NB** 大朗卓为城 · 大朗镇

Opened 2026-01-23. ~10 km from base.

→ See the price ceiling with your own eyes. Check whether premium dark chocolate exists here AT ALL — I could not verify its assortment.

7. 长安 (万科广场 / 万达) · 长安镇

Adjacent strong town, higher income, ranked #7 nationally among 综合实力百强镇.

→ Where 大岭山's spending leaks. The demand you cannot reach from your base town.

8. 松山湖 · 松山湖

Adjacent tech-park population; also has a Sam's 极速达 node.

→ Closest analogue to a genuine premium buyer for an 81% bar.

10. Shelf-audit sheet — fill this in store by store

Four checks per store. Photograph the shelf before you count — recall is unreliable and per-kg maths needs the pack sizes.

	Check	What to record	Why it decides the placement
A	Dark-chocolate facings by price band	Count SKUs per 50–100 g in each band: <¥30 / ¥30–60 / ¥60–120 / >¥120	Our bar is ~¥512/kg equivalent. The band must already exist or we are creating a category, not entering one.
B	Where the imported set sits	Own-brand vs imported gondola vs gift box vs checkout	A destination aisle (Sam's) and a facing (a mid-tier hypermarket) are completely different commercial asks.
C	Claim language on pack	Does ANY package print a functional claim? Photograph it if so	Prediction from the Sam's evidence: none do — everyone stays compositional. If a claim exists locally, that changes the §2.5 compliance calculus.
D	Format	Single bar vs multipack vs daily-count pack; note g per unit and per-kg price	The 15 g × 13 daily pack beat us on per-kg in China. Check whether that format is on shelf locally.

Per-store tally (photocopy or photograph this block)

Store	A: bands found	B: placement	C: claims?	D: formats	Notes

11. Provenance and open items

VERIFIED: CCFA 2024 百强 ranks/store counts/sales deltas; 美宜珉 store registry; Sam's Dongguan #1 in 寮步镇 and #2 signed for 厚街镇 (¥5.11 亿 / 2 万㎡ / opens end-2026); 嘉荣荟 寮步 opening 2025-09-28, 3 万㎡, 100+ brands; 领尚购物中心 2014 and 沃尔玛 大岭山玉屏路 address; 大岭山 '百货、商业街初期阶段' + population outflow (赢商网).

REPORTED: Sam's per-store revenue; JiaRong 3rd-gen KPI set; all closure dates; 超盒算 NB 大朗 opening and 2026 expansion intent.

ESTIMATE: every sales-per-store figure except JiaRong's chain average — arithmetic stated in each caption; the positioning-map coordinates are qualitative, not measured.

TO CONFIRM — do not present as fact:

- The 大岭山 嘉荣 closure. This is a netizen report quoted inside a DeepSeek answer and I could NOT corroborate it. Treat JiaRong's Dalingshan presence as unknown, not closed. One phone call settles it.
- Whether 超盒算 NB 大朗 carries premium dark chocolate at all — this determines whether it is a price ceiling risk or irrelevant to our category.
- Whether the 领尚 anchor Walmart is still trading. I verified the registered address, not live status.
- JiaRong's current total store count (160+ vs ~140 figures circulate); CCFA gives 97 supermarkets only.